

Counseling Conference Proposal Assignment

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Author Note

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I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

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Title

Interpersonal Supervision: How Polyvagal Theory can be Integrated into Counselor Supervision

Abstract

Counselor educators are often faced with the dilemma of how supervisees are impacted by the effects of past trauma on their therapy. There is a need to care for supervisees' mental and emotional health as we assess them for the dispositions necessary to continue emerging as counselors. Polyvagal theory and the modalities and interventions that have arisen since its inception are effective ways of regulating emotions and allowing for the processing of past trauma as it shows up in current relationships. This presentation is focused on mental health supervisors and counselor educators searching for effective methods of caring for supervisees' mental and emotional regulation during supervision sessions.

Learning Objectives

- The participant will evaluate current supervision practices.
- The participant will explore the implications of polyvagal theory for supervision practices.
- The participant will develop new practices for supervision based on the integration of polyvagal theory with supervision.

Bio

Ray Wagoner has been a licensed associate counselor in Arkansas for the past four years and is currently a doctoral student at Liberty University.

Upon graduating with a Master of Arts in clinical mental health counseling, Ray joined a team of counselors treating diverse and various clientele. After successfully establishing a counseling practice, Ray was given the opportunity to supervise graduate counseling students.

Supervising these students has become a passion for Ray. The privilege of mentoring emerging counselors was the impetus for Ray to begin a doctoral program in the Fall of 2022. It is his future aspiration to invest his knowledge and skills in the successful development of many potential counselors representing the racial, ethnic, and gender diversity of the globe.

As well as a gifted therapist, Ray is also an accomplished speaker and educator. Ray honed these skills through years of training and reprised in his previous career as a minister. These accomplishments are carried forward in his future endeavors, and much of what he experienced and learned through this previous career continues to inform and expand with counseling and supervision. He desires to use these skills to advocate for mental health professionals in all stages of their careers and all aspects of their work. He wants therapists to know they matter more than the work itself.

When Ray is not in the office, he spends time with his wife of 31 years and his two children, their spouses, and his two granddaughters, his heartbeat. Ray's mental health journey has been personal and professional, and he is healthier mentally, emotionally, and physically now than he was when he started this journey ten years ago.

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